

AI Agent Payment Control Checklist

Use this before an AI agent can spend stablecoins, pay for APIs, buy data, or trigger any machine-to-machine transaction.

Core rule

The chain can prove value moved. It cannot prove authority, delivery, or ledger fit.

01 Request record

- ☐ Original user/system request is stored
- ☐ Resource, vendor, amount, token, chain, and purpose are captured
- ☐ Prompt/instruction that triggered payment is replayable

02 Authority rule

- ☐ Agent has written spend boundary
- ☐ Per-payment and daily limits exist
- ☐ Blocked vendors/resources/jurisdictions are explicit

03 Payment proof

- ☐ Wallet address and signer are recorded
- ☐ Transaction hash or payment receipt is stored
- ☐ Stablecoin/chain/network fees are captured

04 Delivery check

- ☐ What the agent received is stored
- ☐ Service/data/API response matches what was requested
- ☐ Failed or partial delivery triggers exception review

05 Reconciliation

- ☐ Payment maps to internal ledger/category
- ☐ Duplicate/retry payments are detected
- ☐ Wallet and accounting records can be matched

06 Human review

- ☐ Human approval is required for high-risk/unclear payments
- ☐ Exception queue has an owner and SLA
- ☐ Reviewer can replay request → rule → payment → delivery → audit

Decision

If any box is unclear, do not increase autonomy. Improve the receipt, review, and reconciliation layer first.